

EE5203 Microprocessors — Syllabus

2026-2027 · Istanbul Kültür University · Electrical & Electronics
Engineering

What this course is

EE5203 develops embedded-system competence through a C-first STM32 pathway. You first build reliable Embedded C foundations, then learn enough register-level programming to understand the machine, and finally use the STM32 HAL to implement increasingly complex peripherals and an integrated project of your own.

Four ideas shape every week:

1. **Embedded C comes first.** Four full lectures build the C you need; everything later assumes it.
2. **Register literacy, HAL fluency.** You implement GPIO directly on registers once, so that when you use HAL afterwards you know what it does.
3. **Labs fade their scaffolding.** Early labs walk you through the workflow; later labs hand you a specification and expect a working, explained result.
4. **The project starts early.** You see the destination in Lecture 1, form teams mid-term, and demonstrate working subsystems as milestones — not one big demo at the end.

Learning outcomes

By the end of the course, a successful student can:

1. Write, compile, debug, and test Embedded C programs.
2. Explain the Cortex-M memory, register, and exception model.
3. Configure GPIO, timers, PWM, ADC, UART, and a synchronous serial peripheral using an appropriate combination of CMSIS register access and STM32 HAL.
4. Design interrupt-driven, non-blocking embedded applications.
5. Interpret datasheets, reference manuals, timing diagrams, compiler messages, debugger state, and peripheral registers as engineering evidence.
6. Integrate, test, document, demonstrate, and individually explain an STM32-based embedded system.

Tools and hardware

Item	What we use
Board	ST Nucleo-F401RE (provided in the laboratory)
Configuration	STM32CubeMX (pin configuration and project generation)
Development	VS Code with the course STM32 profile (edit, build, flash, debug)
Where things run	Laboratory PCs are fully set up; personal installation instructions are on the L01 lab reference page

Weekly rhythm

Each lecture package on this site has the same parts, used in the same order:

1. **Prepare** — a short study task and the pre-lab quiz (taken in CATS, two attempts, highest score counts).
2. **Learn** — the theory session and its study sheet.
3. **Practise** — a 30-45 minute worksheet; worked solutions are released in CATS after the corresponding session.
4. **Lab** — the lab guide, with an individual checkoff and a short oral check. Every lab follows the same cycle: warm-up, foundation checkpoint, independent core task, individual modification, oral check.
5. **Review** — a mastery checklist and exam-style questions inside the study sheet.

Graded pre-lab quizzes and homework are **only** in CATS — they are not published on this site. Announcements, submissions, and the weekly calendar schedule also live in [CATS](#).

Course sequence

Lecture numbers describe instructional order, not calendar weeks.

ID	Topic	Central performance	Project step
L01	Embedded systems, C toolchain, and debugging	Build, flash, debug, and modify Blinky	See example projects
L02	Values, decisions, loops, and arrays	Process a sensor-data array in one C file	Identify project inputs

ID	Topic	Central performance	Project step
L03	Functions, arrays, strings, and modular C	Decompose the sensor program into functions and files	Identify processing functions
L04	Pointers, structures, bits, registers, and GPIO	Control PA5 through CMSIS registers	Individual idea canvas
L05	GPIO and hardware abstraction	Rebuild GPIO with HAL and compare the two interfaces	Teams form; project launch
L06	Interrupts and the NVIC	Implement and explain an event-driven application	Proposal and block diagram
L07	Timers and non-blocking time	Generate periodic events without blocking delays	Design review
L08	PWM and motor control	Generate and control timed output signals	First peripheral milestone
L09	Input capture	Measure signals you generate	Measurement milestone
L10	ADC and sensor acquisition	Acquire, scale, and validate analog data	Data-acquisition milestone
L11	The bridge to assembly	Read the disassembly behind your C	—
L12	I2C and SPI	Interface a synchronous serial device	Sensor/display integration
L13	DMA, displays, and integration	Integrate peripherals and diagnose faults	Working prototype
L14	Demonstration and defense	Demonstrate, test, and individually explain the system	Final assessment

Assessment

Assessment combines a midterm (including an individual toolchain practical), laboratory performance (individual checkoffs plus pre-lab quizzes and homework), the term project (proposal, milestones, integration, demo, report, and oral defense), and a final examination. Official weights follow the [ECTS course record](#); any clarifications are announced in CATS.

Laboratory credit reflects **directly observed performance**: checkoffs are individual, and every lab ends with a short oral check where you explain your own work.

Project timeline

Point	Milestone
L04	One-page individual idea canvas
L05	Teams form; preliminary topic
L06	Proposal: problem, block diagram, components, minimum viable system
L07	Design review: pins, peripherals, data flow, responsibilities, risks
L08-L09	First hardware milestone — one input or output peripheral working
L10	Acquired and validated sensor data
L11-L12	Communication / integration milestone
L13	Readiness review: working prototype and test evidence
L14	Demonstration, report, presentation, and individual oral defense